Once a request is authenticated and you know who is making the request, you can determine whether they're allowed to execute an action on your server. This process is called *authorization* and is the focus of this chapter.

Before we dive into code and start looking at authorization in ASP.NET Core, I'll put these concepts into a real-life scenario that I hope you're familiar with: checking in at an airport. To enter an airport and board a plane, you must pass through several steps: an initial step to prove who you are (authentication) and subsequent steps that check whether you're allowed to proceed (authorization). In simplified form, these might look like this:

1. Show your passport at the check-in desk. Receive a boarding pass.
2. Show your boarding pass to enter security. Pass through security.
3. Show your frequent-flyer card to enter the airline lounge. Enter the lounge.
4. Show your boarding pass to board the flight. Enter the airplane.

Obviously, these steps, also shown in figure 24.1, will vary somewhat in real life (I don't have a frequent-flyer card!), but we'll go with them for now. Let's explore each step a little further.

